agreed to make funds available against shares and securities. These were sent to him with Vicaji. Shortly afterwards, Vicaji informed Sorabji on the phone that the businessman had changed his mind and proposed to retain the securities against his deposit in the bank. This phone call came at 11 pm and Sorabji on getting this news immediately repaired to the office of the businessman. When there was no word from him till 2 pm, Hirjibhoy feared that he might have committed suicide on failing to raise the funds. But by 3.15 am Sorabji returned after successfully arranging the money and the family heaved a sigh of collective relief. The family need not have worried as Sorabji was too courageous a person to take such a drastic step. His courage and imperturbability would be on display on numerous occasions in the future where it would also have a salutary effect on his own staff, who taking their cue from Sorabji, did not succumb to panic.

Sir Pherozeshah Mehta who was in the hill station of Matheran near Bombay with the then Cowasji Jehangir asked his companion if he could help the Central Bank. Sorabji was summoned to Matheran and asked to bring a complete list of securities the Central was in a position to offer. After two days of discussions, Cowasji agreed to borrow on his own account against his securities to enable him to advance funds to the bank. When the Bank of India (the Central's great rival at the time) came to know about this, they tried to convince Cowasji against it, and when that failed, rejected his application on technical grounds. The attitude of the Bank of India is a telling commentary on the atmosphere prevailing in banking circles at the time. The Central Bank was viewed as a rival to be put down regardless of the impact of such a failure on the public or Indian banking. The run on the bank worsened when news of the imminent failure of the Indian Specie Bank became public since it was common knowledge that the Central Bank held a large number of shares of the Indian Specie Bank which had an uncalled liability attached to them. Some of these shares, though in the possession of the Central Bank as security against advances to customers, were in the bank's own name, giving rise to fears that the bank was likely to face trouble on this account.

When Cowasji Jehangir's rescue plan failed, Sir Pherozeshah Mehta handed over the title deeds of his own personal properties in Bombay to Sorabji to pledge and raise money. This prompted the other Directors to follow Pherozeshah's example. (It is said that Sorabji sold his wife's